



Building Career Readiness Through Self-Knowledge

Today we explore how understanding yourself becomes the foundation for career success. We'll connect self-awareness to practical career readiness—discovering how knowing your values, strengths, and growth areas guides your development, builds genuine confidence, and helps you match with roles where you'll truly thrive.

- ❑ **Action Item:** Keep a notebook or digital file ready—we'll have several in-class activities and homework exercises throughout this session.

- Mr. Santosh Katti, Asst. Professor, Dept. of CA



The Self-Centric Process: Your Development GPS

The self-centric process is a practical, continuous cycle that centers your personal and professional development on accurate self-awareness. Rather than chasing external benchmarks blindly, you use insight about who you are to set meaningful goals, experiment with new behaviors, gather feedback from the real world, and thoughtfully recalibrate your approach.

01 Awareness Understand your current state	02 Assessment Evaluate strengths and gaps	03 Goal Set specific targets
04 Action Run micro-experiments	05 Feedback Gather external input	06 Recalibration Adjust and iterate

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The Self-Centric Process: Your Development GPS

Think of it as your personal GPS system. You start by identifying your current position—your values, skills, and circumstances. You set a destination based on your authentic goals. You follow the route through deliberate action and small experiments. When you hit traffic or roadblocks, you receive feedback signals and adjust your path accordingly. The system constantly recalculates to keep you moving forward.

Quick Activity (1 minute): Write down one core value that matters most to you right now. Examples might include continuous learning, financial stability, social impact, creative expression, or academic-personal life balance. Keep this value in mind as we progress.

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Why Self-Centering Matters: Practical Benefits

A self-centric approach delivers tangible benefits throughout your career journey. When you understand yourself deeply, you achieve better role fit—choosing positions that align with your natural strengths and values rather than forcing yourself into ill-fitting molds.

Focus energy on areas that matter most to your goals rather than scattered efforts. Present yourself authentically in interviews and networking, which builds trust and attracts opportunities that genuinely suit you.

Better Role Fit

Choose positions aligned with your authentic strengths and preferences, leading to higher satisfaction and performance

Efficient Development

Focus learning energy on skills and knowledge that advance your specific goals rather than random skill collection

Authentic Presentation

Communicate your genuine value proposition with confidence, attracting opportunities that truly match

Greater Resilience

Handle setbacks more effectively when grounded in self-knowledge and realistic expectations

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Why Self-Centering Matters: Practical Benefits

"A student who recognizes they thrive with structured tasks chooses project roles accordingly—consistently delivering quality work while avoiding the burnout that comes from fighting against their natural working style."

Emphasize on pragmatic experiments—small, measurable changes that produce visible results. This approach removes the overwhelm of massive transformation and replaces it with achievable progress.

- **Pair Activity (2 minutes):** Share with a partner one recent decision you made that could have improved with better self-knowledge. What would you do differently now?

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Understanding Self-Belief: Your Performance Fuel



Self-belief is your conviction that you can take action, learn from experience, and achieve your goals. It combines self-efficacy—confidence in specific tasks like public speaking or coding—with a general optimism about your capacity to grow and adapt.

Think of self-belief as fuel for your career engine. Different sources provide different grades of fuel, and some conditions burn through it faster than others.

Quick Task: Note one past small success you can remind yourself of before your next challenge. Keep it specific and real.

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Four Sources of Self-Belief

Mastery Experiences

Your past wins and successes—the high-octane fuel. Each time you accomplish something challenging, you prove to yourself that you're capable. This is the most powerful source.

Vicarious Learning

Watching peers succeed at similar challenges. When someone like you achieves a goal, you think "if they can do it, maybe I can too." Observational learning builds confidence.

Social Persuasion

Encouragement and feedback from mentors, peers, or coaches. Positive reinforcement tops up your belief tank, while constant criticism drains it quickly.

Physiological States

Your physical and emotional condition. Stress, fatigue, and anxiety burn belief faster. Rest, preparation, and positive emotions preserve it.

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Practical Example:

Mock interview practice provides mastery experience. Watching a classmate successfully navigate their interview offers vicarious learning. Your peers' and well-wishers encouragement adds social persuasion. Managing your stress before the real interview protects your physiological state. Together, these sources compound your self-belief.

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Self-Qualification Factors: What Employers Actually Look For



Technical Competencies

Hard skills specific to the role—coding languages for developers, financial modeling for analysts, design software for creatives. - often verified through projects or certifications.



Behavioral Attributes

Reliability, punctuality, follow-through, and professional conduct. Consistent meeting attendance, deadline adherence patterns build this reputation over time.



Values Alignment

Integrity, mission fit, and cultural compatibility. Do your core values align with the organization's purpose?



Learning Potential

Intellectual curiosity, adaptability, and agility in acquiring new skills.



Soft Skills

Communication clarity, teamwork capability, problem-solving approaches, emotional intelligence. These enable you to work effectively with others and navigate complex situations.

Activity: Review the five factors above. Identify which three you believe are your current strengths. For each one, jot down one specific piece of evidence—a project, an experience, or a pattern that demonstrates that strength. Be concrete and honest.

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Classroom Activity: Personality Test

Personality Test (16Personalities.com)

(10 mins)

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Continue Your Journey

You've taken the first steps toward a self-centric approach to career development. Remember that this is an **ongoing process, not a one-time exercise**.

As you gain experience, receive feedback, and encounter new challenges, you'll continuously refine your self-knowledge and adjust your trajectory.

- Stay curious about yourself
- Seek honest feedback regularly
- Document your growth journey
- Iterate based on evidence

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What is the Self-Centric Process?

1. Awareness: Noticing the recurring pattern of anxiety in public speaking settings.

2. Assessment: Completing a brief self-assessment checklist on speaking confidence.

3. Goal: Setting a specific, measurable goal to ask one concise question in two upcoming classes.

4. Action: Rehearsing a scripted question and recording a practice clip for review.

5. Feedback: Requesting peer feedback on their delivery and reviewing their own practice clip.

6. Recalibration: Adjusting next week's plan based on the feedback received, perhaps focusing on vocal projection or a different phrasing strategy.

- Mr. Santosh Katti, Asst. Professor, Dept. of CA

Why a Self-Centric Approach Matters

Better Role Fit

Your choices align with your authentic strengths and values, leading to more satisfying and effective professional contributions.

More Efficient Learning

Targeted practice based on identified gaps means you develop capabilities faster and more effectively.

Increased Authenticity

Operating from a place of genuine understanding reduces cognitive strain and enhances your professional presence.

Greater Resilience

A clear sense of purpose and self-knowledge sustains effort through setbacks, fostering long-term growth and perseverance.

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Understanding Self-Belief

Self-belief is your conviction in your ability to act and learn, a powerful fuel for all your endeavors. It comprises your belief in succeeding at a particular task—and a broader optimistic orientation towards challenges.

Sources of Self-Belief (Your Fuel Tank)

- **Mastery Experiences:** Direct past successes provide the strongest evidence of capability. These are your high-octane fuel.
- **Vicarious (Indirect) Learning:** Observing peers or role models succeed shows you what's possible and that you can do it too. This helps top up your tank.
- **Social Persuasion:** Encouragement, constructive feedback, and mentoring from trusted sources can boost your confidence.
- **Physiological/Emotional States:** Your physical and emotional well-being significantly impacts belief. Stress or fatigue can act like a fuel leak, weakening your conviction.

For example, preparing for a job interview:

- **Mock interview practice** (mastery)
- **Watching a peer ace a similar interview** (vicarious learning)
- **Positive reinforcement from a career coach** (social persuasion)

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Sustaining Momentum

Schedule Practice Blocks

Dedicate specific, non-negotiable times in your calendar for your micro-experiments. Consistency is key to building new habits and skills. **(Diary)**

Set Feedback Reminders

Proactively schedule reminders to request feedback from your peers or mentors. Make it easy for them by providing specific questions.

Maintain an "Evidence Folder"

Keep a running log or digital folder of dated artifacts: recorded clips, annotated project snapshots, feedback notes, and reflections. This provides concrete proof of your development.

Treat Experiments as MVPs

Adopt the product development mindset: each micro-experiment is a Minimum Viable Product (MVP). Release, gather user feedback, and iterate quickly.

- Mr. Santosh Katti, Asst. Professor, Dept. of CA



Empowering Your Career Journey

You have the tools. Now, go build your evidence.

By embracing the self-centric process, you are not just learning; you are actively shaping your professional narrative with data-driven proof of your capabilities. This approach transforms abstract self-improvement into a powerful, demonstrable asset for your career advancement. **(Diary – as the documentary evidence of your improvement)**

Remember, every small experiment, every piece of feedback, and every reflection contributes to a robust portfolio that speaks volumes about your ability to learn, adapt, and succeed.

"The best way to predict the future is to create it."

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Personality Assessment Overview: The OCEAN Model

This module introduces a powerful framework for self-knowledge:

The OCEAN (Big Five) personality model.

We'll explore how understanding these five core domains can strategically inform your career decisions. We will delve into each domain, its key facets, and practical interpretation tips.



Personality Assessment Overview: The OCEAN Model

The objectives are:

- Define each of the Big Five factors.
- Identify typical facets and behaviors associated with each trait.
- Interpret personality profiles for personal development and career alignment.
- Practice a brief self-reflection exercise to apply these insights.



What is the OCEAN (Big Five) Model?

The OCEAN model summarizes personality into five broad, relatively stable domains: **Openness**, **Conscientiousness**, **Extraversion**, **Agreeableness**, and **Neuroticism** (sometimes called Emotional Stability when inverted).

Think of OCEAN as a simple dashboard with five gauges, each showing your temperament tendencies.

Openness

Curiosity, creativity, and openness to new experiences.

Conscientiousness

Organization, dependability, and goal-directed planning.

Extraversion

Sociability, energy, and positive emotionality in interactions.

Agreeableness

Cooperation, compassion, and trust in social relationships.

Neuroticism

Emotional stability and how you respond to stress

Openness to Experience: Exploring New Horizons

Openness to Experience reflects an individual's curiosity, imagination, and preference for novelty and variety. It measures how receptive you are to new ideas, unconventional values, and diverse experiences.



Key Facets

- Intellectual curiosity
- Aesthetic appreciation
- Creative imagination
- Preference for variety over routine



High Scorers: Prone to emotional swings, anxiety, and irritability. They feel "highs and lows" more intensely

Low Scorers: Calm, secure, and resilient under pressure. They tend to remain emotionally steady.

☐ Classroom Activity

Reflect on a recent moment when you actively sought novelty and another time you distinctly preferred routine. Which of these environments truly energizes you the most?

Conscientiousness: Driving Towards Excellence

Conscientiousness is defined by organization, dependability, and goal-directed behavior. It's the engine that converts intentions into consistent, high-quality output.



Key Facets

- Orderliness
- Dutifulness
- Self-discipline
- Achievement-striving

High Scorers: Efficient, organized, and plan-oriented.

They are usually high achievers in professional settings

Low Scorers: Easy-going, sometimes careless, and prefer spontaneity over schedules.

Activity Prompt

Identify one specific habit you can strengthen to boost your conscientiousness (e.g., dedicated calendar blocking for important tasks). Commit to trying it for one week and observe the impact. **(Diary Activity)**

Extraversion: Engaging with the World

Extraversion encompasses sociability, assertiveness, and a tendency towards positive emotions. It describes how individuals interact with and derive energy from their social environment.



Key Facets

- Gregariousness
- Assertiveness
- Excitement-seeking
- Warmth



High Scorers:

Outgoing, energetic, and talkative. They recharge by being around other people.



Low Scorers:

Reserved, reflective, and independent. They prefer solitude or small groups to recharge



Activity

In pairs, discuss a context where you feel most energized (e.g., a lively team brainstorming meeting vs. focused solo problem-solving). What are the implications for your ideal work environment and role fit?

Agreeableness: Fostering Harmony and Collaboration

Agreeableness reflects an individual's cooperativeness, compassion, and level of trust in others. It's the social "glue" that helps smooth interactions within teams and organizations.

● Key Facets

- Selflessness
- Compliance
- Modesty
- Trust
- Sympathy

- **High Scorers:** Trusting, kind, and empathetic. They prioritize getting along with others.
- **Low Scorers:** Competitive, critical, and skeptical. They are more likely to challenge others' opinions.



❏ Quick Reflection

Recall a time you prioritized harmony over giving a necessary, constructive critique. In retrospect, was that decision ultimately helpful or costly for the outcome? (

Neuroticism (Emotional Stability): Navigating Stress

Neuroticism, often reframed as low Emotional Stability, describes a tendency toward experiencing negative emotions like anxiety, moodiness, and vulnerability to stress. Conversely, low neuroticism indicates high emotional stability.

01	02	03
Key Facets • Anxiety • Depression proneness • Self-consciousness • Impulsiveness • Vulnerability to stress	High Scorers: Prone to emotional swings, anxiety, and irritability. They feel "highs and lows" more intensely.	Low Scorers: Calm, secure, and resilient under pressure. They tend to remain emotionally steady.

Important Note: Neuroticism is not a moral failing. Self-awareness of this trait allows for the development of targeted coping strategies, such as mindfulness practices, establishing consistent routines, and realistic planning to mitigate its impact.

❏ Activity

Identify one significant stressor you face at home or college. Sketch out one actionable coping step you could take to reduce its impact effectively.

Profiles, Interactions & Contextual Fit

The true power of the OCEAN model lies in understanding how these factors interact. Strengths in one area can often compensate for lower scores in another. For example, high conscientiousness can significantly offset moderate neuroticism when it comes to meeting deadlines.

Similarly, a combination of high openness and moderate agreeableness might be perfectly suited for innovative team roles, fostering creativity while maintaining team cohesion. The effectiveness of any personality profile is highly dependent on the context and specific demands of the role.

Think of trait combinations like ingredients in a recipe—the right mix depends entirely on the dish (or job role) you're trying to create.

☐ Activity

If you are the President of a club, identify the two OCEAN traits that are most essential for you to succeed. Explain your reasoning using a specific example of a challenge you face face."

Student Task

Draft one SMART (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound) development goal based on your most significant insight from one of the OCEAN traits.



Big-Five Assessment

<https://openpsychometrics.org/tests/IPIP-BFFM/>

Download the assessment report (self-verification)

The above link is just for demonstration purpose.

- Santosh Katti, Asst. Prof., Department of Computer Applications

SWOT Analysis for Personality & Career

Purpose:

Turn self-awareness into career action using a simple four-box tool



- Santosh Katti, Asst. Prof., PES University

SWOT Analysis



- Santosh Katti, Asst. Prof., PES University



Strengths: Identify and Showcase What You Bring

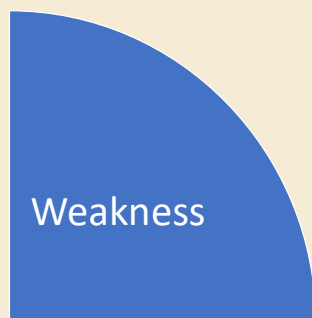


- What counts: reliable traits, demonstrable skills, consistent behaviors, documented achievements
- Examples : punctuality, clear lab reports, club leadership, Excel/basic coding, resilience

- Santosh Katti, Asst. Prof., PES University



Weaknesses: Pinpoint Gaps and Turn Them into Micro-Steps



- Definition: recurring gaps or unhelpful habits (not moral failings)
- Examples: procrastination, interview nervousness, shallow subject depth, weak notes
- Principle: convert each weakness into a tiny, measurable micro-steps

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Opportunities: External Chances to Leverage

Opportunity

- What to look for: Career fair, teacher recommendations, internships, online certificates, scholarships
- Example actions: register for fests, join a relevant club, enroll in a short course, seminars, workshops..

- Santosh Katti, Asst. Prof., PES University



Threats: External Risks to Monitor and Mitigate

Threat

- Typical threats: high competition, prerequisite gaps, family/time constraints, burnout risk
- Impact: threats can block access to roles or reduce performance if unmanaged

- Santosh Katti, Asst. Prof., PES University



SWOT Assesment

Perform a self-analysis on SWOT and generate a report.

The report should also include:

- How will you convert your weaknesses into strengths and
- How do you find opportunities in your threats

- Santosh Katti, Asst. Prof., Department of Computer Applications



Classroom Interaction

Each student has to do a Case study on 3 personalities given in the next upcoming slides.

At the end, one volunteer will share the views / opinion / findings / inspirations / incidents of any one case study of their choice.

Other students can contribute and add inputs

- Mr. Santosh Katti, Asst. Professor, Dept. of CA



Case Study - 1

Case Study on the life of Swami Vivekananda

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Case Study - 1

Case Study on Steve Jobs

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Case Study - 1

Case Study on Kalpana Chawla

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